

Scripting Languages

Laszlo SZATHMARY
University of Debrecen
Faculty of Informatics

Lab #6

- global variables
- file handling

(last update: 2026-08-25 [yyyy-mm-dd])



global variables

```
3   PI = 3.14159      # ”constant”
4
5   counter = 0
6
7
8   def f2():
9       global counter
10      counter = 42
11
12
13  def f1():
14      counter = 5
15      print('f1:', counter)
16
17
18  def f0():
19      print('f0:', counter)
20
21
22  def main():
23      print('PI:', PI)
24      f0()
25      f1()
26      f2()
27      print('main:', counter)
28
29  ############################
30
31  if __name__ == "__main__":
32      main()
```

Convention: ”constants” are written with capital letters

global variables

A global variable can be modified, but then we must use the „global” keyword.

counter is a local variable here, which hides the global *counter*

Global variables are visible from every function. By default, their values cannot be changed.

Reduce the number of global variables that you modify.

If something is a constant, then try NOT to modify it.

reading from a file

```
>>> f = open("text.txt", "r")
>>> for line in f:
...     print(line, end="")
...
First line.
Second line.
Third line.
>>>
>>> f.close()
```

```
First line.
Second line.
Third line.
~
```

text.txt

'\n' is part of a line

or:

```
for line in f:
    line = line.rstrip('\n')
    print(line)
```

Opening modes:

r	--	read
w	--	write
a	--	append

Don't forget to **close** the file!

```
>>> f = open('text.txt', 'r')
>>> lines = f.readlines()
>>> print(lines)
['First line.\n', 'Second line.\n', 'Third line.\n']
```

It reads the whole file and the lines are returned in a list.
'\n' is still part of the lines.

```
>>> f = open('text.txt', 'r')
>>> text = f.read()
>>> text
'First line.\nSecond line.\nThird line.\n'
```

It reads the whole file and the content of the file is returned in a string.

Question: which method(s) to use in the case of large files?

```
>>> f = open("text.txt", "r")
>>> lines = f.read().splitlines()
>>> f.close()
>>>
>>> lines
['First line.', 'Second line.', 'Third line.']
```

Split text to individual lines.

```
>>> html
'<html>\n<body>\n...\n</body>\n</html>'
>>> print(html)
<html>
<body>
...
</body>
</html>
>>> html.splitlines()
['<html>', '<body>', '...', '</body>', '</html>']
>>> html.split("\n")
['<html>', '<body>', '...', '</body>', '</html>']
```

writing to a file

```
>>> f = open("out.txt", "w")
>>> f.write("First method.\n")
14
>>> print("Second method.", file=f)
>>> f.close()
>>>
>>> import sys
>>> print("Evacuate! Reactor meltdown!", file=sys.stderr)
Evacuate! Reactor meltdown!
```

```
First method.
Second method.
~
```

Use this method if you want to write to the standard error.

Old method:

```
5  def main():
6      f = open(INPUT, 'r')
7
8      # Process the content  of the file.
9      # However! If an exception occurs
10     # here, the file won't be closed
11     # correctly.
12
13     f.close()
```

Modern method:

```
6  def main():
7      with open(INPUT, 'r') as f:
8
9          # Process the content  of the file.
10         # Even if an exception occurs, the
11         # file will be closed correctly.
12         # The "with" block guarantees that.
13
           print(f.read())
```

There is no need to explicitly call f.close() .

Example: creating a copy of a text file.

from Python 2.7

```
7  def main():
8      with open(INPUT, 'r') as f1, open(OUTPUT, 'w') as to:
9          for line in f1:
10             to.write(line)
```

Exercise: rewrite this example using the old method.

Exercise

Remove the comments from the file `string1.py` .
For the sake of simplicity, just remove the lines that start with a '#' symbol.
Write the output to a file called `string1_clean.py` .

Link: https://arato.inf.unideb.hu/szathmary.laszlo/pmwiki/index.php?n=EnPy3.20121006d

Exercises #1

homework

1. [20121006d] file handling (removing comments)
2. [20120818h] one hundred 50-digit long numbers (PE #13) [version **B**]
3. [20130218c] character count
4. [20120818g] largest product of five adjacent digits (PE #8)
5. [20130211a] anagram
6. [20130919b] a-z; reversed: z-a (Ouch! Requires thinking!)
7. [20130902e] parentheses
8. [20130902b] Hamming distance

Exercises #2

homework

1. [20120815g] PI verse (*list comprehension*-nel)
2. [20120818i] sum of digits (PE #16)
3. [20130902c] sentence without extra spaces